Using the IT self-service portal

Article KB0010094 | Owner: Service Desk L1 | Subcategory: General | Applies to: Windows 11 laptops (Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840), macOS 14/15 MacBook Pro/Air, Remote workers using VPN, Contractors with sponsored guest accounts, Mobile devices accessing via browser, All employees with Entra ID credentials

Summary

The IT self-service portal at https://it.acme.example lets Acme Global employees log, track, and resolve common IT requests without calling the service desk. It provides a searchable knowledge base, ticket creation, status updates, and direct links to frequently used services such as password reset and software requests. Using the portal reduces wait times and helps keep the service desk free for higher-priority incidents.

Symptoms

- Portal login page loads but credentials are rejected with 'Invalid username or password'
- Page shows 'Access denied - you do not have permission to view this resource'
- After login, the home page displays a blank screen or spinning loader
- Error message 'Unable to connect to the service - please try again later' appears when submitting a request

Common causes

- Incorrect or expired Entra ID password
- Missing or expired device certificate for VPN/Wi-Fi preventing authentication
- Browser compatibility issues (outdated Chrome/Edge/Firefox) or blocked pop-ups
- Network connectivity problems or firewall rules blocking it.acme.example

Accessing the IT self-service portal

Open a supported web browser (Microsoft Edge, Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox) and navigate to https://it.acme.example. The page uses single sign-on via Microsoft Entra ID; after entering your corporate email address you will be redirected to the Acme login prompt. Enter your password and approve the Microsoft Authenticator push notification (or enter the backup SMS code). Once authenticated you land on the portal home page, which displays quick-action tiles for common requests such as password reset, software installation, and hardware assistance.

Logging a request - self-help procedure

Follow these steps to create a new ticket through the portal. The process works the same whether you are on-site or remote.

1. Click the "New Request" tile or select "Create Ticket" from the top-right menu.
2. Choose the appropriate category from the dropdown list (e.g., End-User Devices, Access & Identity, Applications, Network).
3. Enter a concise but descriptive title that summarises the issue or request.
4. In the description field, provide detailed information: error messages, steps already taken, impact on work, and any relevant screenshots (attach using the paper-clip icon).
5. Select the priority based on the impact guide (P1-Critical, P2-High, P3-Moderate, P4-Low) - the portal will suggest a default based on the category.
6. Review the entered data, then click "Submit". You will receive a ticket number and a confirmation email; you can track progress via the "My Tickets" view.

Common actions you can perform

Beyond creating tickets, the portal offers several self-service options that save time for both users and the service desk. From the home page you can launch the password reset tool, browse the knowledge base for known solutions, request standard software packages, check the status of existing tickets, and download approved drivers or firmware. Each tile opens a guided wizard that validates your entitlements before proceeding, ensuring compliance with licensing and security policies.

Service-desk agent workflow

When a ticket arrives via the portal, Service Desk L1 agents see it in the queue with the submitted category and priority.

Agents should first verify the ticket details, add any missing information, and then apply the appropriate troubleshooting steps based on the knowledge base. If the issue can be resolved within the SLA, the agent updates the ticket with a resolution note and changes the status to 'Resolved'. For cases requiring specialist input (e.g., identity-and-access, network, or security), the agent escalates the ticket to the owning group, includes all relevant logs and screenshots, and sets the status to 'Pending - Escalated'. Throughout the process agents must maintain clear communication by adding periodic updates and closing the ticket only after user confirmation.

Verification and troubleshooting

If the portal does not behave as expected, run through these quick checks before contacting the service desk. First, confirm that you are reaching the correct URL and that the site certificate is valid (look for the lock icon). Next, clear the browser cache or open an incognito/private window to rule out stale cookies or extensions. Ensure that your device is connected to the ACME-Corp Wi-Fi (or VPN if remote) and that the machine certificate is present and not expired. Verify that you can approve the MFA prompt; if push notifications fail, use the backup SMS code. Should the problem persist, note any error messages and contact the IT Service Desk via phone extension 4357 (HELP) or the Teams channel "IT Help".

When to escalate

Escalate to the Identity & Access Management team when the user cannot authenticate due to password expiration, account lockout, or MFA device failure; include the user's Entra ID UID, timestamp of failed attempts, and any error codes. Escalate to Network Support if the portal is unreachable from multiple locations, indicating a VPN certificate or firewall issue; provide traceroute results, VPN client logs, and the device's certificate validity dates. For all escalations, attach screenshots of the error, the ticket number (if one was created), and a brief summary of troubleshooting steps already performed.

Keywords: self-service portal, IT portal, https://it.acme.example, log a ticket, create request, password reset, knowledge base, ticket status, service desk agent, escalation, MFA troubleshooting, VPN certificate, browser cache